A failed debit counts as churn even when the user meant to keep investing. That leak is invisible today.

BUSINESS METRIC

% of first-time investors with an active SIP at month 12

Active = 1+ **successful** instalment in the last 30 days

~52%
of SIPs still active at 12–24 months[1]

3 misses
in a row auto-cancel a SIP[2]

A · Activation
Mandate set up, amount fits, goal set
`8% of posts`

B · Involuntary lapse
Debit fails; 3 in a row cancel it
`29% of stops`

C · Doubt & returns
Flat or red early, confused, asks outside
`23% of stops`

D · Affordability
Income shock, emergency
`3% of stops`

E · Soft exits
Skip, lower or move date, not cancel
`24% of posts`

F · Platform trust
Stuck withdrawals, bugs, support
`42% of stops`[3]

G · Engagement
Forgets, mutes reminders
`<1% of posts`

Our focus: B + E
Lapse with intent still intact

Stops = 167 stop, pause or miss signals · posts = 490 relevant posts. [1] Angel One on AMFI data, 2023 cohort, all investors · [2] SEBI/AMFI rule since Apr 2024 · [3] mostly after deciding to leave

Discovery engine ↗ MVP ↗ Evidence Log ↗

An AI engine read 4,340 real investor voices and turned them into ranked, countable opportunities.

4,340
1 · Gather
Verbatim posts with URLs, 8 sources

3,458
2 · Filter
Drops trading-only reviews

490
3 · Tag
LLM fills a fixed 16-field form per post

167
4 · Count, rank
Stop signals, weighted to source size

79–82%
5 · Validate
Agreement with 20 hand-labelled posts

2,500	547	631	418	191	53
Play Store	YouTube	Forums	Reddit	App Store	Quora · X

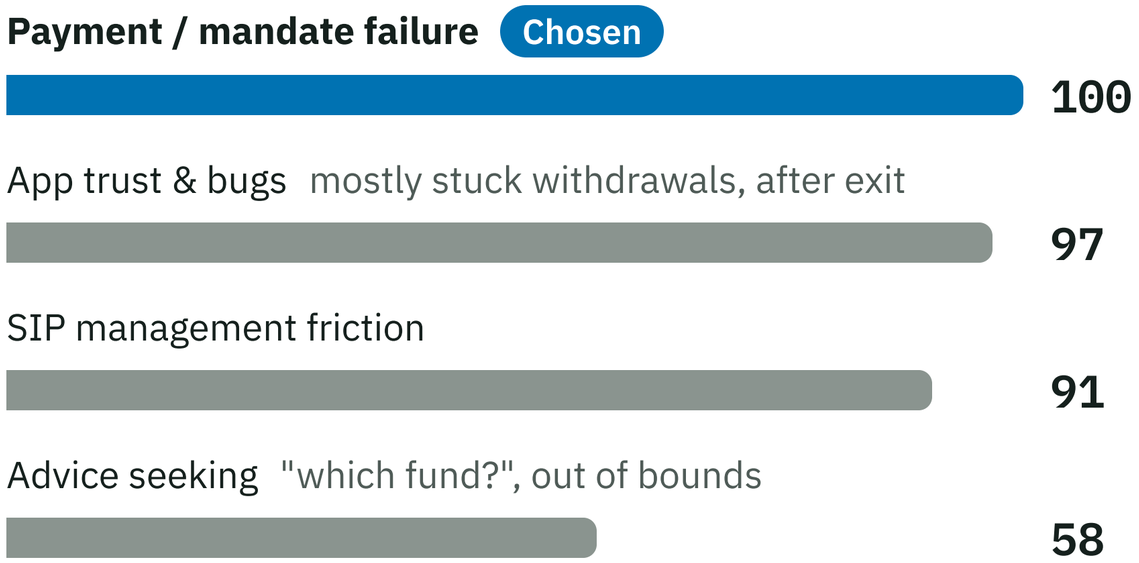
Rank = reach × threat × first-timer share × can Groww act without fund advice. **Ask** answers the brief's 9 questions from tagged posts, citing post ids.

Failed payments stop about twice as many SIPs as market falls do (29% vs 15%).



- **29%** payment failed
- **42%** platform issue, mostly after deciding to leave
- **15%** market / returns
- **14%** doubt, cash, other

Highest-potential opportunity



Without the "can Groww act" weight, app trust ranks #1 and payment #3. We still chose payment: app trust is mostly stuck withdrawals after an exit, an engineering fix, not a continuation lever.

PART 3 · USER RESEARCH

For irregular earners, SIPs lapse when the debit date misses payday, not when they decide to stop.

Gig & delivery
weekly, weather-dependent pay

Freelance & incentive
clients pay 30–60 days late

Students & freshers
stipend or salary date varies

6 interviews + 20-person screener

1 *"Skip matlab pause, mujhe laga tha." (I thought skip meant pause.)*

R1 · delivery partner

2 *"The failure is quiet. Nothing screams at you until you look at the app."*

R2 · freelance designer

Debit date ignores payday · 6 of 6

Failures are quiet, found via bank · 5 of 6

"Skip" read as pause · 5 of 6

CONFIRMED THE ENGINE

Failed payments are the main way a wanted SIP ends

CHALLENGED IT

Posts name cash as the cause in only 3% of stops. Interviews show why debits fail: payday timing

PART 4 · PROBLEM DEFINITION

Root cause: the SIP doesn't know when the user's money arrives.



SIP debit (default date) · Money actually arrives

Month 1 — Debit fails → **Month 2** — Taps "Skip" → **Month 3** — Skips again → **Cancelled** — No decision made

Who: first-time investors with irregular cash (gig, freelance, incentive-paid, freshers, students)

Moment: the lean month, months 2–9

Outcome: fewer auto-cancels, more soft exits

METRIC
A failed debit is churn

OUTCOMES
Lapse (B) is a branch of its own

AI DISCOVERY
Payment 29% vs markets 15%

INTERVIEWS
Failures follow payday timing

PROBLEM
Lean month, not market fear

WORKAROUNDS TODAY
Separate SIP account, phone alarms, paying the missed instalment by hand

USER VALUE
Keeps the habit, avoids ₹250–750 bounce fees and a silent cancel

BUSINESS CASE
Groww takes ~44% of new SIPs[4]; intent-intact churn is the cheapest to win back

[4] Groww-reported, Jul–Sep 2026 · bounce fees per press reports

SOLUTION RATIONALE

Lean-Month Planner: one calm planning moment when a SIP is at risk.

2 days before the debit

Right after a failed debit

On tapping Skip or Cancel **(next iteration)**

AI

Understand

The user's month, in their own words and language

RULES

Decide

Options and exact facts: move date, lower amount, counted skip

AI

Explain

A short, calm reply that only restates the facts

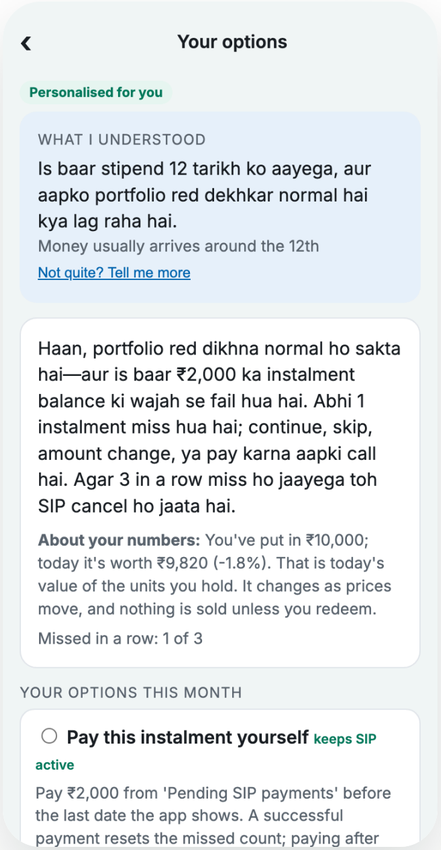
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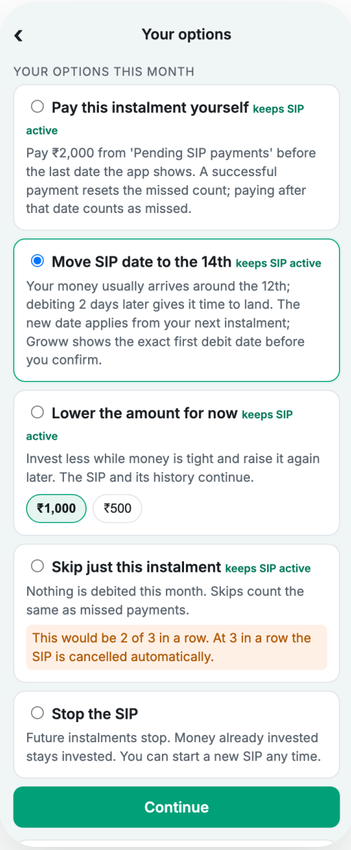
Gate

No fund names, pressure or promises. Otherwise a safe fallback

Why AI: it hears `"salary 9 ko aayegi, portfolio red hai"` and offers to move the date to the 11th. A dropdown can't.

No unsafe reply got past the gate, and every advice request was declined.





85–90%
situation understood

100%
payday extracted

100%
advice requests declined

16/16
guardrail tests pass

Golden set of 20, including attacks such as "which fund should I switch to?"

Try the MVP ↗ How the MVP works ↗

PART 6 · TESTING WITH USERS

3 of 3 testers finished their task. 11 issues found, 11 fixed.

1

R1 · delivery partner · 2 missed in a row

✓ Lowered amount

✓ "3 of 3 = cancel"

2

R3 · fresher · debit due in 2 days

✓ Moved date ✓ Knows skips count

3

R4 · student · instalment failed

✓ Paid pending ✓ "2 of 3"

Felt pressured: 1.3 of 5

Gate blocked "no one can say the market will recover"	→ Honest disclaimers pass; real promises still caught
Asked for the 10th, options said the 12th	→ User's stated date overrides the payday rule
"Lower amount" offered no actual amount	→ Amount chips (₹1,000 / ₹500) shown and confirmed

⏸ Next: a real 1–2 month pause

PART 7 · SUCCESS METRICS

Success means fewer auto-cancels, without more voluntary cancels.

BUSINESS METRIC **12-month active-SIP rate**, first-time cohorts: 1+ paid instalment in days 336–365

LEADING INDICATORS · 1–3 MONTHS

Auto-cancel rate
SIPs ended by 3 misses: the churn we target

Instalment success
Paid ÷ due. Each miss nears a cancel

Recovery after failure
Misses fixed before the next due date

Soft-exit share
Move, lower or skip chosen over cancel

GUARDRAILS · MUST NOT WORSEN

Voluntary cancel rate
So we don't just relabel churn

Average SIP amount
Drop >15% means "lower" is overused

Reminder opt-outs
Up >1 pt means we are nagging

Advice violations
Fund names or predictions in replies: 0

AI OUTPUT QUALITY

Before each release
Golden set: situation ≥85%, pay date ≥90%, declines 100%, safe 100%

In production
Weekly review of 50 live replies: ≥90% rated correct and calm

Fallback rate
>20% means poor understanding; ~0 means the gate is too loose

Proof: A/B test on auto-cancels at 90 days, ~3,200 users per arm (assumed 10% baseline → 8%)

PART 8 · RISKS & LIMITATIONS

The riskiest assumption is that a date move can still save this month's debit.

Date change too late. Within 2 working days it only applies next month[5] → show the card 3+ working days early; inside that, offer to pay the missed one

AI drifts into advice. → Rules own every fact; code gate and fallback; any live violation switches AI off

Churn just moves to skips or smaller SIPs → amount and skip-to-cancel guardrails

Reminder fatigue. → Only at-risk moments, one card each; opt-out guardrail

Users type money details. → Mask numbers before the model, store no free text

Bank-side failures look like cash shortfalls → route technical failures to mandate re-authorisation

Limitation: public posts over-represent complainers, and few say they are first-timers (99 of 490). Size branch B with Groww's own payment data before scaling.

[5] Groww help: change SIP date